



Tanner Castora

Author / Broadcaster

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✂ Tanner_Castora 🔗 youtube.com/watch (Broadcasting reel)

Summary

After establishing myself as an Emmy-nominated broadcaster at a CBS station in Sioux Falls, SD, I transitioned into freelance journalism, focusing on long-form storytelling. Most notably, I authored the biography of John Stiegelmeier, a beloved national championship-winning coach at South Dakota State. Since its release in October 2025, the book has sold several thousand copies.

Professional Experience

Aug 2023 – Present	Author Stig and The Rise of South Dakota State Football - Conducted over 170 interviews to develop a 308-page biography of John Stiegelmeier - Personally raised \$30,000 to fund startup costs including design, printing and production
Oct 2025 – Present	Entrepreneur / Book Manager - Since releasing in Oct '25, I have generated over \$65,000 in sales from the book - Secured placement in 41 retail locations and counting - Coordinated over a dozen book signing events
August 2023 – Present	Brookings Register / Independent Stories 🔗 Published in local newspaper or on personal Medium / Substack page My latest story received 98,000 views on X (link attached)
Aug 2024 – May 2026 Brookings, SD	Brookings Radio Show Host Hosted a weekly sports talk radio show
Dec 2025 – Mar 2026 Madison, SD	Dakota State University Play-By-Play Broadcaster Broadcasted the Dakota State men's and women's basketball games
Nov 2023 – Mar 2024 South Dakota	Big Sioux Sports Media Network Play-By-Play Broadcaster Broadcasting South Dakota HS sports
Feb 2021 – Feb 2023 Sioux Falls, SD	CBS - KELO 🔗 Sports Reporter / Anchor - Discover, film, write and edit weekly stories to be aired by station - Go live at events - Anchor sports blocks on Friday, Saturday and Sunday
Nov 2017 – Mar 2020 Kent, OH	ESPN / Teleproductions Color / Play-By-Play Broadcaster Broadcasted the Kent State men's and women's basketball games on ESPN Plus

Education

August 2012 – May 2015	Strongsville High School
June 2015 – May 2016	South Carolina Upstate Attended University on full Division I basketball scholarship
August 2016 – May 2020	Kent State University • Played on the basketball team for a year before being hired by ESPN Plus to broadcast the games. • Graduated with a degree in Broadcast Journalism

Awards

2026	30 Under 30 Selected for Sioux Falls Business' annual "30 Under 30," recognizing the most impressive young professionals in South Dakota.
2022	Emmy Nomination Upper Midwest Emmys Nominated for best sports feature story
2022	Sportscaster of the Year Nomination South Dakota Broadcasters Association Nominated as the best broadcaster in South Dakota

Personal

April 2021 – Present Sioux Falls, SD	Volunteer Lutheran Social Services • Big brother/little brother program • Mentored same child for 5+ years
September 2026	Wedding Officiant Will be officiating a friend's wedding
July 2025	Organized High School 10-year Reunion Solely organized the gathering

References

John Stiegelmeier, Hall of Fame football coach, South Dakota State
John.Stiegelmeier@sdstate.edu, 605-690-6422

V.J. Smith, Best-selling author / award-winning professional speaker
v.j.smith4@gmail.com, 605-695-5708

Sean Bower, Former sports director, KELO
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